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PR Measurement

AVE Is Dead. Report This Instead.

Your boss will thank you



Raise It With Press Release

swipe →

AVE?

Advertising Value Equivalency

"This article would have cost $X as an ad." Easy to calculate, easy to inflate, and it says nothing about whether anyone changed their mind or bought anything.

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"AVEs are not the value of communication."

— AMEC, Barcelona Principles 3.0 (2020)

Source: AMEC, Barcelona Principles 3.0 (2020)

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4.0

The 2025 Update Is Blunter

AMEC's Barcelona Principles 4.0 say invalid measures such as AVEs **should not be used**. Measure outcomes and impact, not just outputs.

Source: AMEC, Barcelona Principles 4.0 (2025)

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Outputs vs Outcomes

Outputs

- ✕ Number of articles
- ✕ Potential reach
- ✕ AVE (don't)

Outcomes

- ✓ Tier-1 & target-audience coverage
- ✓ Key message pick-up rate
- ✓ Referral visits, sign-ups, enquiries

A One-Page PR Report

- Objective set before the release
- Coverage by quality, not just count
- Did our key message appear?
- What audiences did next (traffic, leads)
- What we will change next time

PR Measurement

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Measure What Matters

1. Save this report template
2. Share with whoever signs off your PR budget

Source:
· AMEC, Barcelona Principles 3.0 (2020)
· AMEC, Barcelona Principles 4.0 (2025)